

Speaker 1 [00:00:02] Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:00:03] Oh, sorry.

Speaker 1 [00:00:05] Oh, okay. So, hi. Thank you again for participating. As I mentioned over email and text, we want to know more about your views on romantic relationships, and we believe your experience and perspective would bring much to the project. I know I already answered it before, but I just now ask again Is it all right if we record the interview and we only use it for transcription and note taking?

Speaker 2 [00:00:26] It is fine.

Speaker 1 [00:00:27] Awesome. Okay, so just some demographic questions. How old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:00:32] I am [46- 50]. I'll be [46-50] years old next week.

Speaker 1 [00:00:36] Happy early birthday.

Speaker 2 [00:00:37] Thank you.

Speaker 1 [00:00:40] How long have you been together with your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:00:42] Since [year].

Speaker 1 [00:00:46] Do you have children?

Speaker 2 [00:00:47] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:00:49] Who lives in the household?

Speaker 2 [00:00:52] My wife, my youngest child of [1-5] and my second or middle child is currently here until next week when they're moving back out for college.

Speaker 1 [00:01:05] Oh, that's nice. And what is your main source of income and what is your current job?

Speaker 2 [00:01:11] I am a [occupation] for a [company].

Speaker 1 [00:01:16] Oh, cool. Cool. And how how would you like us to address your partners? Like boyfriend, partner or girlfriend?

Speaker 2 [00:01:23]. That is my wife.

Speaker 1 [00:01:25] Wife. Okay. Okay. Awesome. Awesome. Um, and can you tell us about your love story?

Speaker 2 [00:01:33] You bet. It's a good one. So we were. We were. We met in college back in about [year], and we were just friends. I thought [wife], who is my wife, was way out of my league. So I never really thought of her as more than that. And there were three friends, my friend [wife], [friend A] and [friend B], and they were all figures back. [wife] and Cara were roommates. [wife] grew up in [Country A] and was going to school in [State A],

where I'm from, and the dark gray winters of [State A] really did not do well for her. For someone who grew up with the sun always around her. So eventually she realized she didn't want to be there. It was depressing. She didn't want to be an engineer. She enjoyed going to school in the West when she had to go to high school, because in [Country A] you have to go abroad when you enter high school. And she liked [State B] in that area, so she ended up in [State C]. And so we kept in touch. And she came out to visit one time and I started realizing I had a crush on her. I was she was I had longer hair and she was she was braiding my hair and I fell asleep. And she she was very tempted to put some Henna on my nose. But I was doing job interviews, but I was like, oh, well, you know, I kind of, you know, I started to think of her romantically and she, on one of the one of the visits, ended up hooking up with a mutual friend of ours. And he started telling me everything in the gym about it. And I was getting mad. I'm like, Why are you telling me this? I realize that I was jealous. I was like, Well, this is really weird to discover. So flash forward, [wife] and I are going to be in the same wedding party of a mutual friend of ours who's getting married, and I'm the bit. I'm in the wedding party. She's in the wedding party. And we're driving down and I say, Gosh, would it be really weird if [wife] and I ever get together? And that would be We are great and we're poor college kids. So we all had to share a hotel room together. And so it was distributed. And for some reason [wife] and I were in the same bed and I was very, very nervous and very, very aware of how much I liked. So I was like trying to be in my own space. And I remember she accidentally touched me. And so then the next day at the wedding, I dance with [friend A], dance with [friend B]. But I did not dance with [wife] because I'm like, There's no way that she's not going to tell that I like her if I do that. And so she got really mad about that. And so then I was I was drinking and and so forth. And then we went back to the hotel room and she went to go use the bathroom. I said, You know what? I'm going to just get in the bed and stay in the middle of the bed. And if she asked me to move out and she didn't ask me, she started kissing me. And then I started crying because I was like, This is going to ruin our friendship. So then on the way back to college, because she was here for a couple of days, we she said something to the effect of we can't tell anybody because there's there's too many there are too many of our mutual friends that were absolutely in love with [wife]. And for some reason, that was a big deal to like, Oh, wait a minute, we might be together. We then had our first date at the movie seven, which is an incredibly bad movie to have as the first date. And after a couple of days, she was getting ready to go back to Utah. And I'm like, This is someone who is like one of my best friends. I never pretend to be anything in front of her that I'm not. And so I said to her, Would you ever think about marrying me? She kinda said. I think I went in. Then I just blurted out, Will you? And I'm like, Holy crap, I'm going to scare this. This is [1-5] days. I'm going to scare this poor lady away. And she thought about it for a second and she just said yes. That was it. And so then I finished up college and moved to [City], and I thought I'd be there [1-5] years, tops. And that was [16-20] something years later. I'm still here and we're still married.

Speaker 1 [00:05:39] Wow. That's a really incredible story. I really like it. Wow. You're also a really great storyteller.

Speaker 2 [00:05:44] Thanks, friend. I some people pay me for this stuff.

Speaker 1 [00:05:50] Um, how would you compare your quality of relationship compared to that of, like, your friends relationship? And why would you say so.

Speaker 2 [00:05:57] Better in every way Because it is. Well, you know this because we started out as friends. We have so much that we have to fall back on. You know, there's not just like, Oh, we're romantic and we're in love and you're so hot, blah, blah, blah. And I

mean, you know, she's hot, but I it's one of those things of look where we like, we connect in an emotional and mental level where we like each other. We like hanging out with each other, but we're also very independent and we can be without each other. So we're fine on our own. But we like being we we like hanging out. I think that, you know, I have a lot of friends who who have very similar relationships. But but there's also this just mutual respect that like we we like to help each other out sometimes. Sometimes that's not always the the the fact like I was I went through a very selfish period where I was just going off and I was traveling and performing and and doing all kinds of stuff and and just leaving her alone with the kids and had to realize that I was more interested in not disappointing strangers than my own family. So there's, there's these evolving things that you go through in a relationship where you have to admit that like, Hey, this isn't working anymore. We have to make some adjustments. And I think some of my friends have done that. Some of them and they have their marriages have survived. And it's it's a shame because I think both of us were willing to evolve, listen in change if we needed to or. Establish firm boundaries if we get to. And listen to each other's boundaries and respect. I Look, I don't think that's unique, but I do think that it helps.

Speaker 1 [00:07:41] Mhm. Right. Yeah. That makes a lot of sense. Can I ask how many romantic partners you've had in the past?

Speaker 2 [00:07:52] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:07:54] How many?

Speaker 2 [00:07:57] Sure. Gosh, not not a not a whole lot. Right. Right up to [wife]. It was I was in a very long term relationship. That didn't work out. And then I was in I went immediately into a different relationship. And then that didn't work out. And then I kind of just floated until [wife]. So it was, you know, as far as, like, serious, like. Adult kind of relationships. Maybe two as far as like a lot of hookups that I shouldn't have gotten into. Several more than that.

Speaker 1 [00:08:46] And how would you compare the quality of your current relationship to the those relationships that you had previously?

Speaker 2 [00:08:55] Well, you know, I think it would be a trite to go like, well, it worked so it's better. You know, I think that I was ready for this kind of a relationship, for this kind of an honest relationship where there's a lot of mutual respect. And the other nice thing is that Julie is very low drama and accepts me for who I am. So back east, I think I was I kind of saw so many examples of relationships in my family that were very high drama. And then therefore, I thought that's what relationships should be like. There should be like a lot of nonsense and so forth. And it really it's so easy. It's so easy to be married. Did you hear? It really is like she's friendly, she's community, she communicates, she has her moments. But, you know, we made a agreement a long time ago to never go to bed mad. And I can count maybe on one hand the amount of times we've broken that. But it's it's it's. It's wonderful.

Speaker 1 [00:09:55] That's amazing. Wow, that sounds really great. And for you, what makes a relationship high or low quality? And why would you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:10:04] Um, I think there's there's about, like three or four factors that make a relationship high quality. I think communication that you can have in a safe place is number one where you don't feel like somebody you have to walk on eggshells or that

somebody's going to fly off the handle just because you say something. Being able to be generous is the second is to recognize when someone needs you and you take that time to actually make it so that you're there for them. Being able to stand firm on your own and say, I need this. These are my needs so that you can take care of yourself and not be offended by the other person taking care of themselves. And I do think a physical part of the relationship is important. You know, it's one thing to be romantically, mentally into someone, but it's it's wrong to say that the physical part doesn't matter. The physical part does matter because you have to also evolve physically. You know, our relationship physically at our early twenties doesn't look as similar the way it does in our late forties. It's just different and it's not going to look the same in [6-10] years. But being okay to again, go back, listen, be generous, stay stand the ground and communicate what your needs are. All that folds into the physical part as well as the emotional part of our relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:11:32] Yeah. Yeah, that makes sense. And you mentioned law about communication. When would you say that you had good communication?

Speaker 2 [00:11:42] Oh, gosh. I can't think of a time when we really haven't. I think I think the the key is to kind of just take a step back and recognize when something might have been miscommunicated or might have been missed. And sometimes you get really, really ornery about it because it's like, how could you miss this? But being able to also have the presence of mind of saying, like and be empathetic and say, I think I know how you miss this, or I think I know how I didn't communicate this well enough. And we do that often. And [wife] is a [occupation], so she's also able to she has language that's available to her that I don't where she sees certain patterns of behavior in her clients that she can then transpose into our relationship. I tend to be more emotional and outgoing, so a lot of times I'm out there just offering things to her before she will, where she might call me out for something that I wouldn't think to think to mention. Uh.

Speaker 1 [00:12:42] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:12:43] But if you're looking for, like, specifics, like a specific time, you know, we, we, we went through this weird. Space in the mid [Year] where, you know, things didn't seem like they were clicking. And we tried going to marriage counseling and it was a disaster because the marriage counselor definitely took my side on a lot of things and it made [wife] feel bad and and guilty for feeling the way that she felt, which I didn't think was right either. But it was it was one of those things of like, well, she's on my side, but, you know, it's hurting my wife. And so we really had to like, kind of come together and say, okay, look, this isn't working. We need to figure out how we work and reinvest in our relationship. And it was a reinvestment, an emotional and a physical and and just a friend way that that that helped to keep our marriage going.

Speaker 1 [00:13:47] Yeah. Yeah, That's amazing. Um, and for you, I know you could touch on communication, but, like, in cases, like, something different, like, what are the most important things in a relationship and why would you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:14:00] You know, I think I've kind of said it. It's it really is being able to communicate in a safe way. And being able to voice your feelings in a way that you can be heard and not hurt. So so that you're trying to give out something in a way that has no other effect than to say, this is how I'm feeling. And to hear it in no other effect than to be empathetic and say, I've heard what you've had to say. That is your truth. Here is mine. The the ability to laugh and enjoy each other's company in the stupidest moments. Like my wife watches a lot of terrible TV and I'll go watch the terrible TV with her because that

means I get to snuggle friends to hang out with her and make fun of her terrible TV, and then she's mad for that. No, she just she just she just gives me like, like weird looks, but she's like a weirdo and I love her. And and also, you know, it's interesting. I think you go through, like, waves of everything ever. Every kind of communication, of physical, of everything else. And and, you know, recently we we we were watching bad TV together and we watched a Netflix show like How to Build a Sex Room. And that was like I was like, what a dumb show. Let's see what the show is. But then there were some really interesting, like, truths about, like, relationships and and being vulnerable with each other that we really kind of invested in and said like, you know, this is more than just about like some weird dungeon thing. It's about like, how people communicate and how people say their needs and in a safe way again. And, you know, it really has reignited some something of a spark. And so now it's back into that physical part of it where it's like, okay, well, you know, we're reinvesting in that part too.

Speaker 1 [00:15:49] Yeah. Yeah. And it's kind of a different kind of question. But for you, what is love?

Speaker 2 [00:15:57] Um, I think. I don't know. I could be very poetic about this. I think love. Love is is the. The other person's shaped hole they leave inside you. It's. It's sort of that you're missing, and I can feel it. And I know what this is. And I had that with my children. I have that with my loved ones. Like, you know, the the joy of putting that person back inside is just wonderful. But I really think that for me, love and even just not a romantic love has always been the joy of seeing someone else happy. You know, it's and being happy in their happiness, there's sort of that selflessness that also is not selfless. It's it's like a you make me happy because you're happy. So I want to make you happy. So I'm happy. And there's some weird loop that happens. And that's that's kind of that's kind of fun for me. And but the other part of it is very true. The other part the other side of it is that when you're sad, I'm sad. I'm wrecked. [wife] went through breast cancer a few years ago and watching her try to put a smile on, struggle through her moments and just just wrecked me, just really destroyed me. And you try to be there for each other and you know you're going to cycle back. But but like their sorrow is your sorrow. And their joy is your joy.

Speaker 1 [00:17:29] Uh, no, that was very poetic. I really enjoyed that. Thank you. Um, how important is love in a relationship, do you think?

Speaker 2 [00:17:42] In a romantic relationship?

Speaker 1 [00:17:44] Yes.

Speaker 2 [00:17:46] Very, very. It's what separates every other kind of relationship, Right. It's that it's that idea that I can see you in every moment, and I'm still there. Like, I can see you. I can have a conversation with you while you're on the toilet. That's fine. Like, I can. I can see you struggling, giving birth, and in late and splayed open like a chicken. And I'm fine like these. Because those are the moments that get you through the hard, hard stuff. I like to come back and. I think people think of romantic love as the only kind of love, and that's why they lose it. They forget that there's all this other love that sort of forms that calculus of love, where it's the friendship, it's the respect, it's the generosity, it's the empathy, it's the it's the physicality. It's it's the moments that like, like a certain look will just send you back [16-20] years and you're just back there again. All of those things that are both magic and and very mathematical all kind of get together at the same time versus like, you know, a friendship. I love. I love my friends. I truly do. I don't wanna have sex with them. You know, I don't want to like I want to talk with them on a toilet song with you. But,

you know, it's it's it's there's there's a calculus that's just there's so much to it. You know, it's hard to say like what love is singly. It has to be what? Love is multiplicative.

Speaker 1 [00:19:27] Hmm. Yeah. Yeah. And how do you know that your partner loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:19:33] Because they tell me. Hmm. It's it's. It's wonderful because I get to have, like, little shining moments where she'll share me. She'll share stuff with me or that are just about her day or like, what she's struggling with or, you know, we'll kind of get like, Google gaga on each other and, like, tell each other why we love each other, like what things we admire about the other person. And, uh, you know, the, the other thing is that, you know, we miss each other, and she misses me. And she'll tell me that, like, if I don't if I'm away on a trip, she'll talk about, like, how she couldn't sleep because she's just too used to having me there, that she misses me. So I think, I think vocalizing it and also showing me small things where like shows she'll go get me a treat or remember me for when she's going out to get coffee. Even though I don't like coffee, she'll be like, You want to get something? I'm like, Yeah, something that's like full of chocolate caramel that doesn't taste like coffee. I will love it. But, you know, it's it's it's little it's little generous moments as well as, like, big sweeping moments that kind of, like, add up again, the multiplicative nature of love that I get from her.

Speaker 1 [00:20:53] Yeah. Yeah, that makes sense. And it's also really heartwarming to hear going on like a different role. What would you say are some challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:21:03] I think I think the biggest challenges are just time and finding time to do all the things that we want to do and not just with each other, but apart from each other. So, you know, I think a lot of the issues when we were struggling was just like we didn't really have time because we were both so busy with like kids and like when she's really tired and I'm really, you know, petty and that I don't get to, like, have her time with me then when I want to have that time. You know, I think recognizing that and like letting go of the selfishness of like love has to be on a schedule or love has to be a certain way and then recognizing what love is. Those were the things that, like, helped in those moments. But we you know, it's. It's. The biggest challenges we've had have always been about communication and time. Making sure that we understand what each other is actually saying. And sometimes we misinterpret and we have to repair that. Or that we wanted the person at a certain moment and we couldn't get access to them.

Speaker 1 [00:22:17] Do you and [wife] fight?

Speaker 2 [00:22:20] Oh, yeah, yeah, yeah. She has a really mean left hook. Oh, no, she. You know, it depends. You know, I'm. I like to joke around a lot. Sometimes I play by play to heart, and she'll tell me, and sometimes I play to her in the wrong way and it gets miscommunicated. We had one recently where she had a problem with one of her clients, and then she went to go ask me something and I said, I said something in a way that reminded her of her client. And so she took it that way and just stormed off. She's just really upset, crying. And I'm like, Well, what happened here? She said, What she thought I said. I said, Actually, I didn't say that. I said this. She was still is she she accepted that she was mistaken, but she was still sore. And so she had to come back from that. So I kind of had to stay with her until she got back to a point where she didn't want to punch me in the face. But, you know, I also you know, I'm hard person to to deal with sometimes because I don't do well with change If something is not going according to plan or like something

going on behind schedule. Like, I get very OCD. I'm like, Hey, hey, we got to get going. And she'll call me out and say, like, you need to chill out. All right. I appreciate you told me that, but I don't, I'm not chill. And then she'll get mad at me and I'll feel that. And I'm like, Okay. But, you know, it's it's rarely big. Most of the things that we we we argue about, we can come back from and it's just fine. Or we talk through and she she definitely her counselor mind definitely kicks in and says this is how I'm processing it. And I'm like, okay.

Speaker 1 [00:24:04] Yeah. How long do your fights usually last?

Speaker 2 [00:24:07] Not very long. There's only been very few. There's been a very few moments, I guess. I can count probably one hand where it's been like an all day. Or she just like, she's just mad. She went like she once had a dream that I did something that I didn't do. When she was mad at me in the morning, she would show up. There was a. Usually she usually it's like she's mad at me. I got to figure out a way to, like, repair what I've done. There's only been one time I can really remember. Like she cashed a check for my brother that had been postdated. And I told them I wouldn't cash it, but she did it by mistake. And I was super mad about it because my brother was mad about it. And it kind of like had. And I wasn't talking to her and like, for the whole day. But yeah, it's, it's that that's probably the longest we've ever been like mad at each other. Now there can be times where we send something in and we hold grudges or something comes back that's like, That wasn't cool. And now I remember that. That wasn't cool. There was a time where I she hurt her knee, tearing up some flooring in her old house, and she had exposed both the kids to chickenpox and they asked her not to. So she was laid up with basically a torn meniscus and two kids with chickenpox. And I was scheduled to go to [City A], to go perform at a comedy festival. And I'm like, I want I still want to go. And so my comedy partner's wife offered to watch her. And I went I got stuck there in [City B]. And it was a bad show and it was like, bad idea. But she always remembered that. And that actually came up in marriage counseling. And she's like, you know, I remember this and this really upset me. And I tried to let it go and I can't. So it's not like it's not like we were an act of fight from that moment on. It's just one of those things that with this memory of when I hurt her surfaced. And we have to do something to figure that out. So that's probably like more like under the covers, like, like Undercurrent kind of, you know, this thing happened and I think we've gotten that out and beaten it out enough to be able to like, heal from it. But, you know, it was it wasn't my best moment. And we've had to have a conversation about I apologize a million times. And I recognized that this was not okay.

Speaker 1 [00:26:18] Yeah. How often would you say you usually fight?

Speaker 2 [00:26:22] Not very often. We play a lot. So sometimes it's it's, you know, like I'm teasing her and she's like, All right, enough. Like, alright But yeah, it's not very often like I maybe. Maybe once a month if, I don't know, like we have like a moment where we snap at each other and then we come back, we're like, I'm sorry, I'm sorry. And that's it. And it doesn't last. Really. It's kind of nice. It's very much like I said, she's very easy. She's very low drama.

Speaker 1 [00:26:52] Yeah. And how would you say I mean, I think you kind of touched on this a little bit, but how would you say you usually resolve these kinds of conflicts.

Speaker 2 [00:26:59] By talking about them? Talking about how we feel, talking about our perspective on things. I think I kind of default to just apologizing and in trying to defuze things I'm used to like mediating and diffusing things. And so to me, I'd rather just apologize for something than be right. And then we can kind of talk about it. But

sometimes I'm real ornery. Like, we we just kind to talk things through, and then. You know, we come to the realization that this is stupid and let's just move on.

Speaker 1 [00:27:33] Yeah. And aside from communication, what are other ways that you maintain your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:27:42] Time and, you know, like not making other people's time more important than my families. That was a big lesson for me. And just being present, you know, like watching bad TV and just like, while [wife] plays like [wife], like she plays a lot of, like, puzzle games, so she's always on her phone, just kind of like multitasking, like watching bad TV and like playing puzzle games. So but like, you know, if I just hang out with her, I'm there in the room and that's kind of fun. And also just, you know, being being playful. In multiple ways. It's like being you know, I like to tell her, ask her like, Hey, I told you I love you today, you know, and just, you know, be like all of you, and then I'll kiss you and I'll tell her how beautiful she is. And then she'll be like, Oh, yeah. And then she'll fart at me or something like that or something dumb, you know? It's just one of those things where like, we're constantly, like, just playing at each other. And yeah, and then also just like trying to be physical with each other and making time for that and, and talking about that. And and kind of wrapping each other up. You know, those are those are all the things that like, help us like connect both like, you know, physically, mentally, emotionally and just as friends.

Speaker 1 [00:29:05] Yeah. Um, and would you say that the relationship is good for you and why?

Speaker 2 [00:29:13] Yeah, it's. It is. It's good. It's good because. Of all the things I listed, it's good because we communicate. It's good because we give each other space. Good because we find ways to spend time with each other and in a meaningful and dumb ways. It really works because I can go and she doesn't make me feel bad about going. But if I stay, she makes me feel great for staying.

Speaker 1 [00:29:40] That's awesome. And would you say that the relationship changed you? And in what way if it did?

Speaker 2 [00:29:46] It made me a lot. Kinder, but she makes me kinder, like I come from a very unkind background. And I have a lot of. Examples of relationships that are not very kind, that are high drama. And she helps me to remind myself that that's not the norm, that that doesn't have to be how things are. And, you know, and she also she also makes me like a lot. I don't know. She makes me a lot kinder and a lot less mean, which is which which is like two ways of saying the same thing, but not because I'm a mean person. And so she tempers me a lot. And like, I try to figure out ways that I can be more like her because I'm like and.

Speaker 1 [00:30:36] And what about [wife]? Would you say that she's changed in the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:30:40] I don't know. She's definitely. More so. So. Something funny that happened when we first got together was our two friends. [Friend A] and [Friend B] pulled [wife] aside and basically were like, [Participant's] a really nice guy. Don't fuck this up. And then my friend [Friend C] basically called her a whore and yeah, basically, yeah. And said, you know, but like, we, you know, she she's like, no, you're you're my thing, you're my dude. And and she's my girl. And so it was. One of those one of those things maybe where

she's more domesticated, I don't know, because she traveled the world in like she was she was so far out of my league. So I'm like, I was this kid from [State A] who'd never been anywhere. She been around the world. Like like she she she had all all these relationships in her past. She she was very like, this is who I am. And that's you guys got to fucking deal with it. But, you know, at the same time, you know, now I'm the one who's traveling more and like, but she's kind of finding love, travel with our middle child, right? You know, and and our other children. So I think maybe she's changed because she's more staid and maybe a little bit more domestic and not tame, but grown up. Yeah. But she's still very independent and she's still very headstrong and still very able to, like, stand her ground with anybody and super knowledgeable and empathetic about other cultures. So it's it's hard for me to to see like that she's really been changed by our relationship. I guess you have to ask her.

Speaker 1 [00:32:29] I will. And this is kind of a question that need to ask, but do you feel safe in the relationship and why do you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:32:40] Yeah, and I use the word safe quite a few times. So I think I feel very confident in saying that. And the reason why is because. There was this one moment in the beginning of a relationship and. When I proposed to her right, I never had a ring. She gave me her ring. And then I went down to [City B] and I was at a show and that was in the middle of like a mosh pit and doing stupid stuff that I did when I was a kid and I lost the ring and I'm like, That's it. That's it. I lost this person because she's going to freak out because I lost her ring. And I told her about it, and I was just so afraid that she was just going to freak out. And I was like, Sure. I just why? I'm like, I need to be honest. So I told her I lost the ring. Oh, man. [Participant] I really like that ring. Oh, well. And that was it. And it made me feel so safe in respect to other relationships where I belong, really high drama kinds of relationships. And and again, you know, I feel safe bringing up uncomfortable things with her that she may not want to hear, but she will hear. And we'll talk about it together. And it may not be the best conversation we've ever had, but it is a conversation that's honest and we respect each other's truths and we can move past.

Speaker 1 [00:34:06] Yeah, that sounds really amazing. So the next part of this interview is going to ask you, like a series of questions based on like a scale. So I'm going to share my screen. Um. Okay. Can you see this?

Speaker 2 [00:34:24] I can.

Speaker 1 [00:34:25] Okay, So I'm going to ask you the questions that are in there and then you can answer based on like the number, and then I'll ask you why you answer them.

Speaker 2 [00:34:35] All right. Hey, do me one favor. Yes. Super type-A OCD, And this will, like, really affect me. Can you hit that orange? Okay, button.

Speaker 1 [00:34:44] The what?

Speaker 2 [00:34:45] The orange. Okay..

Speaker 1 [00:34:48] Yes. Thanks. Should I turn it into a slideshow, would that make it easier for you to.

Speaker 2 [00:34:52] Yeah, that'll be fine.

Speaker 1 [00:34:54] See. Okay, here we go. Okay, so my partner usually listens to me.

Speaker 2 [00:35:00] I would say eight or nine.

Speaker 1 [00:35:03] Okay. And why not like seven?

Speaker 2 [00:35:09] Seven? Because she does. She really does. And, like, if I. If I say something, she. If she misses something, it's very rare. And. Oh.

Speaker 1 [00:35:22] How do I switch? Oh, no.

Speaker 2 [00:35:23] You got it.

Speaker 1 [00:35:26] Oh, okay. I'm so sorry. Okay. My partners, my partner, usually is responsive to my needs.

Speaker 2 [00:35:34] Um, I would say this is a seven.

Speaker 1 [00:35:36] Okay. And why not a six or eight?

Speaker 2 [00:35:42] Because I think being responsive doesn't mean that you cave in. It's that you hear them and recognize them as true.

Speaker 1 [00:35:53] Yeah, that makes sense. That makes sense. And how satisfied are you with your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:35:59] Completely satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:36:01] Completely satisfied. Okay. Okay. Based on this scale, what number would you say you are?

Speaker 2 [00:36:10] Ten.

Speaker 1 [00:36:11] Okay. And why not like nine or eight?

Speaker 2 [00:36:16] Because everything that I might have been a nine or an eight at certain low points of our relationship or even like, lower. But like, honestly, everything about our relationship cliques right now, the communication, the sex, the emotions, the the fact that we just like each other. I can't I would be terrified to try to go date and find somebody who was the equivalent of her just because. And, you know, we kind of joke about like she always goes, well, I'm going to go first. I'm like, not the way I live. And and but our agreement is always that [wife] will always say, I'll probably never have a relationship after you. And I said, I will. Like, I can't. I can't be alone. But I'll never find someone as good as you. And.

Speaker 1 [00:37:05] Yeah, but I think she really. That's really beautiful. Okay, that was it for that little scale thingy. So thank you. And sorry. Let me. Okay, So, um, I hope you don't mind if I ask. And feel free to say this is too sensitive for you to share, but I want to know more about, like, your physical into intimacy as a couple. So these days, how often do you have sex?

Speaker 2 [00:37:33] Probably once or twice a week.

Speaker 1 [00:37:36] Okay. And how satisfied are you with your sex life and why would you say so?

Speaker 2 [00:37:41] Very. You know, again, a lot of it comes from that experience. I told you about it because it's such we've communicated our needs in ways that we feel safe, where we're experimental in fun ways, where we listen to each other and make sure that we each other's safe and and heard. And also we communicate our fantasies to each other and just kind of talk through that and say like, here's what is really fun for me and making sure that there are fun moments and, you know, and if things don't go to plan. We don't catastrophize it. I think in the previous in our relationship, I would go, Well, this isn't exactly how it should be. This isn't romantic. And now I'm like, This is fun. Like, we listen to each other, we laugh, we had fun, and it didn't have to be some weird expectation in my head. So, yeah, super, super great. Satisfied?

Speaker 1 [00:38:33] Awesome. Awesome. Okay, so that we're wrapping up now, those like, the bulk of the questions. I'll just like to summarize what we've conversed about in the past 45 minutes. So it's, it seems like you're very satisfied with your relationship. You get a lot of good physical intimacy, but also you communicate a lot, which helps you with conflict resolution. And you don't fight very often, but when you do, it gets resolved pretty quickly. Is there anything else that you would like to add that I haven't mentioned or like that you haven't talked about yet?

Speaker 2 [00:39:11] No, I don't think so. I think there's also like a music and a relationship that happens, especially when you have different milestones, whether they're children, careers, sicknesses, etc.. And I think that all of the stressors that we've had. Have been ways for us to grow rather than to separate. And I think that's that's important in any relationship is that you'll always have something that comes up. That's not quite the script. And how you get through those moments and how you support each other in those moments and and how you also kind of inspect yourself in those moments. That's the important bit.

Speaker 1 [00:39:58] Hmm. Yeah. Yeah. Thank you for sharing. Um, so thank you so much again. Now, before we end, I want to talk to you about how we will handle the data. As a research project, you probably want to be as ethically transparent as possible. And so I wanted to know which data option you be comfortable with. So there's two options. Option one is that transit portions can be shared and none of which can be identified to you. So the de-identified transcript can be read by other researchers and as such.

Speaker 2 [00:40:33] Names would be filtered out, I guess.

Speaker 1 [00:40:35] Yeah. Yeah. And I think anything that would like even identify, you know, like location, like where you live would be taken out as well. Um, so no one can trace it back to you, even if there is no name. Number two is like, if you want to be bolder, you can have like, the whole transcript can be shared and it'll be removed, like sensitive and overly identifying details. And it will also be anonymized. Although in this option, there is minimal chance that someone who knows you can piece together the details in the transcript and narrow down who among their colleagues they believe it is. Although again, no sensitive information will be shared. This is basically just they'll be like more like sensitive information and like identifiable information in this. But they're like still like the

bulk of, like super sensitive information and identifiable information will be removed and name as well.

Speaker 2 [00:41:29] So. I think in my release and in [wife]'s, we both said full transcript, except sensitive details can be shared. So I'll stick with that.

Speaker 1 [00:41:46] Okay. Sounds good. Awesome. Um. Okay. Yeah. Awesome. Okay. So thank you so much again for participating and I know I said that so many times. But I wanted to know if you knew anyone else who might be interested in participating in the study. The way that we're running the study in getting participants is through. So snowball sampling, I don't know how much like, you know, that is, but it's basically like you asked your participants to give you new like interviewees and then you interview those participants and then you get more people to interview. So basically it's like, it's like a snowball effect on a hill. So I kind of make sense. So basically, I was wondering if you knew of any people that were in a relationship currently, like my portion of the of the study that I'm doing right now has to do with. So you're like a heterosexual relationship that has been together for [16-20] plus years. That's one of my parts. And then there's I also need to find LGBTQ couples and non-monogamous couples. So if you happen to know anyone in those kinds of relationships or anyone who knows someone else in those relationships, please let me know.

Speaker 2 [00:43:12] Oh yeah, Yeah. I know people who are poly. I know folks who are non-monogamous. I have friends who've been together [16-20] years plus. I have. I'm I'm going off to go conduct the wedding for friends of mine who are LGBTQ. So do you want like married people that are that are also LGBTQ or just people in long term relationships?

Speaker 1 [00:43:42] They don't even have to be for LGBTQ, LGBTQ. They don't even have to be in a long. They just have to be LGBTQ. And that's like the only where we're less specific with LGBTQ relationships because it's like harder to find participants for that specific realm of relationships so that they can be of any length. Yeah, basically any length and. Yeah. So sorry. This is really confusing. But, yeah, if you want, I can text you, like, more information on, like, what? What we're looking for, and then you can, like, text me back. Does that sound good.

Speaker 2 [00:44:19] Or are you just email to me?

Speaker 1 [00:44:21] Oh, yeah. is email easier for you.

Speaker 2 [00:44:22] You because then you'll have like a longer format that you can you can communicate in. Yeah, I have to go. But yeah, I have. I, I could get you. I guess I could think of like seven off the top of my head.

Speaker 1 [00:44:36] All right. Also awesome, because that would be very helpful. It's been, as I said before, it's kind of difficult to find participants.

Speaker 2 [00:44:42] So I imagine the non-monogamous poly couples is is fairly difficult. But I can I can figure two couples off the top of my head. That would be probably pretty good.

Speaker 1 [00:44:54] Yeah, that would be amazing because that's that's definitely the hardest part. I haven't been able to find anyone for that. So yeah, I think, um, I think at least in my age, that's not as big of a like, I don't know, I personally don't know any non-

monogamous relationships, so it's been difficult to find other people who would be in a relationship, that kind of relationship. Um, but yeah, so that's what's been difficult. But yeah, I, I think it'd be possible, hopefully.

Speaker 2 [00:45:29] So what kind of time frame you're looking for? Um.

Speaker 1 [00:45:34] I don't think there's, we don't basically by the end of October I think. Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:45:40] So I'll try to like, I'll try to get about a dozen couples together or half a dozen couples and that that's attainable and, and then work from there.

Speaker 1 [00:45:48] Okay, Sounds awesome. Okay, great. Thank you so much. I'll Email you the information just so you know, like how to contact people and if you I can even give you like a I've done this before for other people, like a frame of like what to send to people so that they know like what the study is about. Would that be helpful as well?

Speaker 2 [00:46:05] Awesome.

Speaker 1 [00:46:06] You just, like, tell them their names. I'll put a little space. Okay. Sounds good. Okay. Um, so that was all that I had. Um, is there anything else you'd like to mention or share? I'll email you, of course,

Speaker 1 [00:46:19] Awesome. Awesome. Okay. Thank you so much for doing this. Like, thank you so much. This is very fun and I really enjoyed it. Thank you so much.

Speaker 2 [00:46:26] Yeah, well, now you have to go deal with [wife], and she's. She's boring. I don't know. But I love her. She's very. She's lovely in her boringness. All right. We'll talk to you later.

Speaker 1 [00:46:37] Thank you so much.

Speaker 2 [00:46:38] Bye bye.